

1. Materials

Assessed under this heading: the quality of ideas and choice of musical language that candidates present in their compositions in response to the stimulus; the ability to engage with the challenges of a specific type of composition and the disciplines required to formulate appropriate material; aural familiarity with a range of listening as demonstrated in the composition itself and outlined in the commentary.

13–15 marks	Strong, inventive and confidently shaped materials showing aural familiarity with a broad range of relevant language.
10–12 marks	Effective shaping of materials, showing aural familiarity with a range of relevant language.
7–9 marks	Attention to detail in the shaping of materials, showing some aural familiarity with relevant language, but lacking invention or character.
4–6 marks	Materials show a limited aural familiarity with similar models, but awkward in shape.
1–3 marks	Weak and uninventive materials showing little aural familiarity with any relevant models.
0 marks	Negligible materials and no knowledge or aural understanding of possible models.

2. Technique

Assessed under this heading: the ability to use techniques to assemble materials as appropriate to the chosen type of composition. This may include small scale issues, such as text setting, the use of techniques to develop ideas within an unfolding programmatic context or the placing and working of ideas at appropriate timings within a visual medium. The sound mapping of an electro-acoustic composition, the formal structure of a text setting or the overall coherence of a film score may be examples that demonstrate a candidate's grasp of the larger formal considerations of the composition.

9–10 marks	Very secure control of all appropriate techniques.
7–8 marks	Mainly secure control of all appropriate techniques.

1-2 marks	A little technical control.
0 marks	No technical control.

3. Use of Medium

Assessed under this heading: the effectiveness of the chosen sound sources in relation to the brief. The composition will demonstrate the extent of the candidate's understanding of both the technical and expressive potential of timbres or sound sources chosen. Assessment may focus on idiomatic vocal/instrumental writing and/or the appropriate manipulation of sound sources using technology, for example.

9–10 marks	Inventive, wholly idiomatic use of the medium.
7–8 marks	Mostly idiomatic use of the medium.
5–6 marks	Competent use of the medium.
3–4 marks	Simple use of the medium.
1–2 marks	A little understanding of the medium.
0 marks	No understanding of the medium.

Either:

4(a) Notation and Recording

Assessed under this heading: the ability of candidates to communicate their work effectively in both written and recorded format through accuracy of notation and the use of a range of performance/ expressive detail in the score; accurate and expressive aural communication of the composer's intentions in the recording.

9–10 marks	Accurate, articulate score and recording; vivid communication of the composer's intentions.
7–8 marks	Clearly presented score and effective recording communicating the composer's intentions unambiguously but missing detail.
5–6 marks	Mostly accurate score and recording, but lacking some clarity and attention to detail.
3–4 marks	Inaccuracies in the score and limited effectiveness in recording.
1–2 marks	Incomplete notation with a little effectiveness in recording.
0 marks	Notation and/or recording missing.

Or:

4(b) Recording and Commentary

Assessed under this heading: the ability to communicate composing ideas effectively by the submission of a carefully produced recording. Balance, stereo imaging, application of a variety of technical processes to enhance or alter the recorded sound, may be some of the relevant assessment issues when candidates submit a film or vocal composition. Additional technical processes may be involved in the submission of electro-acoustic compositions. Detail in the commentary should include a comprehensive account of the composing process as well as a full explanation of the technical processes/equipment used in producing the recording.

9–10 marks	Very secure control of all appropriate production techniques supported by a comprehensively detailed commentary.
7–8 marks	Mainly secure control of all appropriate production techniques supported by a full and detailed commentary.
5–6 marks	Moderate control of most appropriate production techniques supported by a fairly detailed commentary.
3–4 marks	Limited control of some appropriate production techniques accompanied by an outline commentary.
1–2 marks	A little technical control of production techniques with sketchy commentary.
0 marks	No technical control of production techniques.

